In 2006, I traced the family of R.W.D'E. Ashe in Kildare, Ireland where his grandson Robert Ashe generously opened up his family's papers. These papers offered a different chrome to the overall picture. The warm friendship that he extended to a researcher of his grandfather's assassin continues over the years.

During 1984–85, I had the opportunity of consulting all the surviving issues of the great poet Subramania Bharati's *India*—the weekly that passionately chronicled the ups and downs of the Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company. Ilasai Manian provided access to the photocopies of *India*'s first volume (1906–07); I later consulted its originals in the National Library, Kolkata in 1994. I perused the 1908–09 volume, published from Pondicherry, in C.S. Subramanyam's collection both in original and on microfilm. Miscellaneous issues were consulted in R.A. Padmanabhan's collections (then in his Villupuram home) and at the Maraimalai Adigal Library. Sadly, none of them are alive today, and these collections too, save for those in the National Library, have dispersed. Luckily, copies have been consolidated in the Bharati Memorial Museum and Library, Pondicherry, and in the Bharati Archives of Manonmaniam Sundaranar University at Bharati's birthplace, Ettayapuram.

The library of the Madras Institute of Development Studies has always been my first resort, and I remain thankful to my colleagues there. Other libraries that require mention include the Roja Muthiah Research Library, Chennai; the Periyar Rationalist Library and Research Centre, Chennai; the Gnanalaya Library, Pudukkottai; the Theosophical Society Library, Madurai; the Adyar Library, Chennai; the Regenstein Library (University of Chicago); the Widener Library (Harvard University); and the Library of Congress, Washington, D.C.

Many individuals across states and nations have helped me in my work. It is impossible to name all of them. The following list is illustrative rather than exhaustive.

It was in 1985 that I first went to Tuticorin and Tirunelveli. But for the hospitality and guidance of A. Sivasubramanian—himself a distinguished